Chapter 6

Springhare Dances

SUMMARY. Springhare was playing and dancing and making a sound like *tcoqm-tcoqm-tcoqm*. The god was watching him and said he would go home and get a dancing skin from his son !Xuma. He came back and tied the dancing skin on Springhare, who danced all day, imitating the sound of the rain. The god said "give me the dancing skin so I can go home–rain is coming." But springhare kept on dancing and dancing and refused to give him the dancing skin. Finally a heavy rain settled in and beat down, and it beat the dancing skin into pieces. The springhare was then afraid and went into a hole. The god took a long hook and pulled the springhare out, and then beat him with a digging stick on the small of his back as people do with springhares today, to kill them.

SPEAKER. *Dahm Ti N!a'an*

RECORDED. Kauri, Botswana, 1971

TRANSCRIBED BY. *Hacky Kgami Gcao, G‡kao Martin |Kaece*

ha n|oqm
the springhare
ha n|oqm
2 *the springhare*
ku tcxai tci n|ui te ku ko "tcoqm- tcoqm- tcoqm- tcoqm- tcoqm- tcoqm," ha koe n||ae
was playing around at something and was making a sound like "(onomatop.)," that's what it sounded like

tca tsi ke ha n|oqm ka ge ka ku ’m ka ko ”tcoqm-tcoqm-tcoqm-tcoqm-tcoqm-tcoqm”
that is what the springhare was doing, eating and making a sound like ”(onomatop.)”
ha n|oqm ge te ku djxani te ku n‖a’ibi ha !xui te ko djxani
the springhare began to dance and was flipping up his tail as he was dancing
te ha tsi-g|ae g!u’un ha n|oqm g!u’un ha n|oqm g!u’un ha n|oqm g!u’un ha n|oqm g!u’un ha n|oqm te g!u’un ha n|oqm te
and he came and watched the springhare and watched the springhare and watched the springhare and watched the springhare and watched the springhare and watched the springhare and
ko ”a’an,
said ”uh-uh,
kxoe, n|ang mi u n|ang
wait, let me go and
g!a gua mi !’han !Xuma ko
go home and get from my son !Xuma the
ko |’hun-ma
the dancing skin
n|ang tsi-g|ae |’an a n|ang a !uu n|ang djxani n|ang mi g!u’un a”
and come back and give it to you so you can tie it on yourself and dance and I can watch you”
!aah u te ǂaeh gu ha te
(he) ran off and got it and
n!o te ce tsi-g|ae te ha cete djxani ‖’a tca
hurried and came back and he danced it again
tsi-g|ae |’an ha ko ha te ha !uu ha
came back and gave it to him and he tied it on himself
’hm
hmm
ha g‖aan te g!u’un ha
he spent the day watching him
te ku g!u’un ha
and watched
ku g!u’un ha
and watched
ku g!u’un ha te ka g!a, ka g!a taqm
and watched him and the rain, the rain began to fall
Hoq
(onomatop. imitating the sound of the rain)
”yaih, ha m na |’hun-ma, n|ang mi, g!a, |’an mi, g!a m ku tsi g|ae” te a !xau
”hey, give me the dancing skin so I can go home, give it to me, rain is coming” but he refused
ku djxani te ku djxani te g!a khaua te n|ang
he danced and danced and a heavy rain settled in

n‡a’m !’hun, ha n‡a’m ǂhoma ha ko ǁoh, ha sin n|ang te g!u’un n|oqm te
beat him hard, beat his dancing skin to pieces, he just sat and watched the springhare and
n|oqm koaq te g|ae g!a’ama dom
the springhare was afraid and went and entered a hole
g!a n‡a’m !hun ha te ha !oe g!xa te g!a
the rain beat him hard and he left there and went home
n!o te gu
hurried and grabbed
ǁ’a, Mama, ǁ’a g‡uia he ju ka ku n!ham ha ka du oo ha gu ǁ’a g‡uia
now granddaughter, the springhare hook people use today to pull out springhares , he took that springhare hook
gu ǁ’a !aia
took that digging stick
tsi-g|ae te ha cete du ǁ’a tca te ha
came and he again did that and he
khu te g|ae n‡au koa ke te ha g!xuni ha te ko ”|ahn”
jumped and went over here and he beat him with the digging stick and it went ”(onomatop.)”
ko ha zuhn te !’ang !’oan ha te !ao ha
on the small of his back and knocked him down
m
mm
ee
yes
ee
yes
mama ee
granddaughter, yes
ee
yes
ee
yes